

Section A: Quranic Verses

Chapter 1: **Basic Islamic Beliefs**

Key Points:

Al Aqeeda linguistically is derived from the term **Aqada**. For instance “**aqada the rope**”_when the rope is tied firmly or “**aqada the sale**”_ or “he settled the sale” when a person ratifies and contract a sale or agreement. And Allah says in the Qur’an, “**To those also with you have made a pledge**” (Al Nisa, 33). Allah also says, “**But He will punish you for your deliberate oaths**” (Al Ma’idah, 89).

Therefore, Al Aqeeda or al Itiqad according to scholars of Islam is: the firm creed that one’s heart is fixed upon without any wavering or doubt. It excludes any supposition, doubt or suspicion.

Sub theme 1: Tauheed

- Tauheed is a cardinal principle of Islamic faith
- The concept of monotheism was the primitive objective of the teachings of Holy Prophet (SAWW)
- Tauheed literally means “unification” i.e. “asserting oneness”.

Al Anbiya: (V.22)

لَوْ كَانَ فِيهِمَا آلِهَةٌ إِلَّا اللَّهُ لَفَسَدَتَا ۚ فَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَرْشِ عَمَّا يَصِفُونَ ﴿٢٢﴾ (الأنبياء: 22)

(See translation in the text book)

Brief points:

- Above verse describes the ignorance of polytheists because they have made their gods from amongst the creature of the earth, who do not have the power of life and death.
- Only a being which has these powers is worthy of being worship.
- This is an argument of common nature in favor of the oneness of Allah, which is based on common practice.
- It is also a logical proof of the oneness of Allah, and a great deal of literature is available to explain.
- The argument sovereign, then the command of both would prevail on the earth and in the sky which is not possible, because it is in-conceivable that both of them would have common views on all the matters.

- And if there are differences of opinion which is inevitable where power is shared, there could be conflict, which would always lead to chaos and confusions.
- The thing to note is that if the two gods had to take decision jointly, then neither of them would have been sovereign, and a god with divided sovereignty is not God.
- Allah Says: “No son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along with Him, then each god would have taken away what he had created, and some would have tried to overcome others! Glorified be Allah above all that they attribute to him “(23:91).

Al- Baqara: (163)

(البقرة:163) **وَاللَّهُمَّ إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ الرَّحْمَنُ الرَّحِيمُ**

“And your God (Allah) is One God (Allah): there is no god but He, Most Gracious, Most Merciful”

Brief points:

- Above verse is one of the greatest verses of the Holy Quran
- First part proves Tauheed_ the cardinal principle of Islamic Faith
- Second part of the verse is the denial of polytheism
- And the last part of the verse presents arguments / endorsement for the facts.
- Tauheed means “**Say: He is Allah, the One, Allah, the eternally besought of all! He begets not nor was begotten. And there is none co-equal or comparable to him**” (Al Ikhlas).
- A summary view of the principle (Tauheed) is as follow:
 1. **He is One in the state of His being**, that is, there exist in the universe of His creation no entity like Him. He is without any duplicate or replica and without any equal or parallel.
 2. **He is One in claiming the right of being worshipped**.
 3. **He is One in being free of any conceivable composition**, that is, He is free of segments and fragments, units and organs, substances and elements, atoms and particles.
 4. **He is one in being the anterior and the posterior** that is He existed when nothing did and He will remain when nothing will.
- **Shirk or polytheism** means the **worship of others along with Allah**. It also implies **attributing divine attributes to any other besides Allah**. It particularly implies **associating partners in worship** (invoking, supplicating, rendering obedience to any authority against the Order of Allah, intentions, purpose and determination in act of worship directed

towards other deities, showing love which is due to Allah Alone to others than Him, religious acts performed to show off, being inwardly dissatisfied with the inevitable condition that has been ordained for one by Allah) with Allah of believing that the source of power, harm or blessings is from others besides Allah.

- Al- Rehman: the Compassionate in both worlds
- Al-Raheem: The Merciful in the next world particularly

Al-Baqara (V: 164)

إِنَّ فِي خَلْقِ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافِ اللَّيْلِ وَالنَّهَارِ وَالْفُلْكِ الَّتِي تَجْرِي فِي الْبَحْرِ بِمَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ وَمَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مِنْ مَاءٍ فَأَحْيَا بِهِ الْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا وَبَثَّ فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ دَابَّةٍ وَتَصْرِيفِ الرِّيَّاحِ وَالسَّحَابِ الْمُسَخَّرِ بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ لَآيَاتٍ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْقِلُونَ ﴿البقرة: 164﴾

(See translation in the text book)

Brief points:

- In the above verse, there is a series of signs and proofs in support of the premise that Allah Almighty is really One.
- In this verse Allah Subhanuhu has referred to:
 - ✓ the creation of the universe,
 - ✓ the alteration of the night and the day
 - ✓ the sailing of ships on water
 - ✓ the irrigation and productivity of barren lands through rainfall
 - ✓ the creation and propagation of animals etc
 - ✓ the change in the direction of winds
 - ✓ and the scattered rainy clouds
- All above citations of some manifestations of His perfect power are intended for the service and benefit of mankind.
- This verse portrays that mere objects created by Allah for the service of human beings and not for their worship.
- Also it is a definite reminder for non Muslims that none of their gods was capable of creating a fraction of the above phenomenon.

Ch# 1: Sub-theme_ 2: Prophet Hood:

Verse: 79 A'l Imran

مَا كَانَ لِبَشَرٍ أَنْ يُؤْتِيَهُ اللَّهُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحُكْمَ وَالنُّبُوَّةَ ثُمَّ يَقُولَ لِلنَّاسِ كُونُوا عِبَادًا لِي مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ وَلَكِنْ كُونُوا رَبَّانِيِّينَ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تُعَلِّمُونَ الْكِتَابَ وَبِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَدْرُسُونَ ﴿٧٩﴾ (آل عمران: 79)

“It is not (possible) that a man, to whom is given the Book, and Wisdom, and the Prophetic Office, should say to people: "Be ye my worshippers rather than Allah's": on the contrary (He would say): "Be ye worshippers of Him Who is truly the Cherisher of all: For ye have taught the Book and ye have studied it earnestly." (Al-i-Imran: 79)

Brief Points

- In this verse Allah supported the position of all prophets in general and of Hazrat Isa (Jesus) A.S. in particular.
- The background of this verse is that during the visit of the Christian deputation from Nijiran two persons enquired from the prophet of Islam whether it was his desire that he should be worshipped like Hazrat Isa (A.S.).
- The prophet (SAWW) emphatically repudiated it and said that such an advice from him would be highly inconsistent with his mission. On the contrary he would always insist on exclusive worship of Allah. These verses were then revealed clarifying the issue.
- Following attributes are derived from verse 79 of Al Imran
 - In their inner nature and significance prophets were above all mankind but in spite of this they remained human beings.
 - Prophet Hood is a bounty of Allah, bestowed upon those whom Allah desire to bestow without regard to human efforts and struggles.
 - Whatever prophets present in the form of faith or law emanates from Allah
 - Their souls, feelings, thoughts and conduct are pure. They are infallible.
- Hukum means “ a judgment of legal decision” (especially of Allah), word Hikmat or Hikmah is derived from the word hukm, which means “a sound speech which goes into one’s heart” or it means “ an insight through which one finds out the dictates of circumstances and talks as appropriate relatively

Verse: 07 Al Hashr

وَمَا آتَاكُمُ الرَّسُولُ فَخُذُوهُ وَمَا نَهَاكُمْ عَنْهُ فَانْتَهُوا ۚ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ شَدِيدُ الْعِقَابِ ﴿٧﴾ (الحشر: 7)

“So take what the Messenger assigns to you, and deny yourselves which he withholds from you. And fear Allah; for Allah is strict in Punishment”. (Al Hashr: 7)

Brief Points

- Verse 07 of Al Hasher emphasize on the obedience of prophet (SAWW).
- Al Hashr refers the the exile of Bani Nadir, a jewish tribe of Al Madina (for treason and projected murder of the prophet) and the confiscation of their property.
- The last preceding verses are related to the siege of Bani Nadir in their fort and their evacuation from it.
- The present verse (V: 7) is related to the spoils acquired from the Jews without a fight with them. For the disposal of spoils of war Allah ordered that spoils acquired in this case belonged to Allah and His Apostle, an they were meant for the Apostle, his relatives, the orphans, the needy and the wayfarer who were short of money to pursue their journey. The wealthy muslims were excluded.
- Allah advised the Muslims to obey the prophet (SAWW) particularly in the present case and generally during his life. Whatever he authorized them to take they should take, and whatever he forbade them , they should abstain from it.
- Fear of Allah is a very strong indicator of faith in Allah. Taqwa means consciousness, awe or fear of Allah, which inspires a person to on guard against wrong actions and eager for actions which please Allah. It is a feeling which incites a believer's faith, eagerness, love and respect for Allah. It inspires in a believer the need to respect Allah's boundaries, gives him an uncompromising determination in seeking Allah's approval and a constant vigilance.

V: 3 Al Maida

الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتِمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا ﴿٣﴾ (المائدة: 3)

“This day I have perfected your religion for you, completed my favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion”.(Al Maida: 3)

Brief Points

- The combination of circumstances in which this verse was revealed is special. This was a time when the conquest of Makkah and almost of all Arabia was complete. This is the day of Arafa, this Arafa fell on Friday. The place is nothing less than the plain of Arafat. The time is after Asr.
- The verse is a great news, a solemn reward and an abiding hallmark of distinction for Islam and Muslims and for the Ummah at large.
- Three rewards are: Perfection of Faith, Completion of Divine Blessing, and Shariah of Islam as the Chosen Way for the Muslim Community.
- Perfection of faith refers to the perfection of all limits, obligations, injunctions and refinements in personal and social behavior as necessary for the true faith. Now there is no need to add to it, nor there remain any probability of a short fall.

- Completion of Muslims means that Muslims do not have to depend on any one anymore. Allah has himself given them supremacy, power, authority. They can use these to promulgate and implement the imperatives of this True Faith.
- Third reward is that Allah has, by his creational prerogatives, authority and wisdom, chosen the faith of Islam for this Ummah which is perfect and complete in all its aspects, and on which depends the ultimate Salvation.
- Islam is a religion of nature. It is free of any dogma or mystical proposition. It avoids all complicated rituals. It rejects all mortification and exaggerated asceticism. It takes fully into account that man has been created weak.

Ch# 1: Sub-theme_3 :[Here After](#)

Verse :48, Al Baqara

وَاتَّقُوا يَوْمًا لَا تَجْزِي نَفْسٌ عَنْ نَفْسٍ شَيْئًا وَلَا يُقْبَلُ مِنْهَا شَفَاعَةٌ وَلَا يُؤْخَذُ مِنْهَا عَدْلٌ وَلَا هُمْ يُنصَرُونَ ﴿٤٨﴾ (البقرة:48)

Then Guard yourselves against a day when one soul shall not avail another nor shall intercession be accepted for her, nor shall compensation be taken from her, nor shall anyone be helped (from outside).

Brief Points

- The verse describes the reality and truth about the day of Judgment and accountability.
- In the preceding verse Children of Israel are reminded of Allah's favour on them.
- Reference of Al Baqar V: 80 (translation: and they say the fire (of punishment) will not touch save for a certain number of days. Say: Have you received a covenant from Allah, truly Allah will not break his covenant or tell you concerning Allah that which ye know not?).
- Verse 94 of Al Baqar for reference (translation: Say (unto them): if the abode of the hereafter in the providence of Allah is indeed for you alone and not for others of mankind (as ye pretend), then long for death (for ye must long for death) if ye are truthful.
- It is reminded that the reality of the day of judgment is that on that day no soul will avail anything from another, no intercession will be accepted , no compensation will be received, and no one will they be helped. There will be neither mutual bargaining nor befriending.

Verse: 5, Al Hajj

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِن كُنْتُمْ فِي رَيْبٍ مِّنَ الْبَعْثِ فَإِنَّا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ مِّن تُرَابٍ ثُمَّ مِّن نُّطْفَةٍ ثُمَّ مِّن عَلَقَةٍ ثُمَّ مِّن مُّضْغَةٍ مُّخَلَّقَةٍ وَغَيْرِ مُخَلَّقَةٍ لِّنُبَيِّنَ لَكُمْ ۖ وَتُقَرَّبُ فِي الْأَرْحَامِ مَا نَشَاءُ إِلَىٰ أَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى ثُمَّ نُخْرِجُكُمْ طِفْلًا ثُمَّ لِتَبْلُغُوا أَشُدَّكُمْ وَمِنْكُمْ مَّن يُتَوَفَّىٰ وَمِنْكُمْ مَّن يُرَدُّ إِلَىٰ أَرْذَلِ الْعُمُرِ لِكَيْلَا يَعْلَمَ مَن يَعْدُ عِلْمٌ شَيْئًا ۚ وَتَرَى الْأَرْضَ هَامِدَةً فَإِذَا أَنزَلْنَا عَلَيْهَا الْمَاءَ اهْتَزَّتْ وَرَبَتْ وَأَنْبَتَتْ مِن كُلِّ زَوْجٍ بَهِيجٍ (الحج:5)

“O mankind! if you have a doubt about the Resurrection, (consider) that We created you out of dust, then out of sperm, then out of a leech-like clot, then out of a morsel of flesh, partly formed and partly unformed, in order that We may manifest (our power) to you; and We cause whom We will to rest in the wombs for an appointed term, then do We bring you out as babes, then (foster you) that ye may reach your age of full strength; and some of you are called to die, and some are sent back to the feeblest old age, so that they know nothing after having known (much), and (further), thou seest the earth barren and lifeless, but when We pour down rain on it, it is stirred (to life), it swells, and it puts forth every kind of beautiful growth (in pairs)”. (Al-Hajj: 5)

Brief Points

- In the preceding verses the terror of the Day of Resurrection was described. The present verse gives examples in favour of the reality of the Day of Resurrection. The verse revealed in particular reference to Nadr Ibn al-Harith who started a controversy.
 - First is the example of the creation and formation of human beings indirectly the product of the dust and directly that of human matter (seed). The verse deals with different stages through which the foetus passes in its mother's womb before taking a human form. It is gradually developed into a clotted blood and lump of flesh after passing through different stages.
 - Shaped or unshaped: the human seed which completes its full term in the womb and is destined to be born as a normal human being is meant by shaped whereas a seed which is destined to be aborted is unshaped. Or a foetus which completes all the stages of growth and development and whose limbs and other organs of the body are healthy, normal, a proportionate is shaped. On the other hand, a foetus whose limbs are deformed or disproportionate is unshaped.
 - All these faculties grow strong as time passes until they reach their full capability.
 - “Miserable old age” means the stage of life when human faculties and senses begin to degenerate.
 - The second example is re-enlivening of the dead soil. . When it receives rainfall, it is stirred into life, and in the course of time, as fixed by Allah, it grows attractive vegetation which is generally in pairs.
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